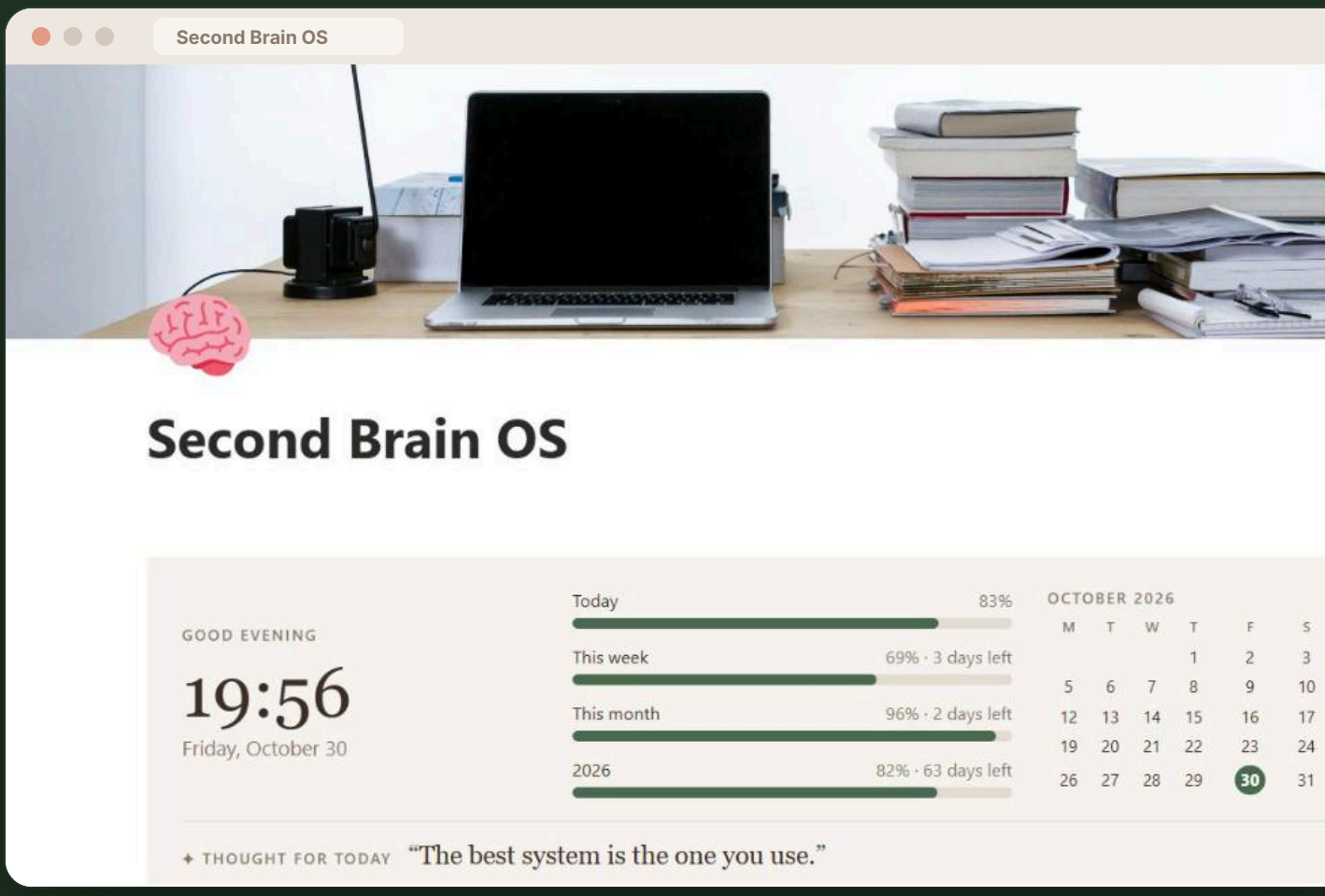
SF SystemForge

BONUS GUIDE · 15-MINUTE READ

Notion *for beginners*

Feel at home in Notion and in your Second Brain, without reading a manual.



01 Get set up

FIVE MINUTES, ONCE

1

Create your Notion account

Go to notion.com and sign up, or log in. Use the same account on your computer and your phone.

2

Duplicate the template

Open your template link and click **Duplicate** in the top right corner. Pick your workspace. Your Second Brain is now yours.

3

Get the apps

Notion has apps for Mac, Windows, iPhone and Android. Everything you add syncs everywhere.

4

Pin it to your favorites

On the home page, click ☆ at the top right. On your phone, do the same for 📱 **Mobile home**.

5

Open “Start here”

It's the first link in the menu. Keep the example data at first: it shows how everything connects.

TIP

Turn on **Full width** (••• at the top right) on the home page. Your dashboard gets room to breathe.

02 The 6 things to know

LEARN THESE AND YOU KNOW NOTION

Blocks

Every line is a block: text, a checkbox, an image. Drag the ⋮⋮ handle to move one.

The / menu

Type / on an empty line to add anything: headings, to-dos, toggles, callouts.

Pages

Pages hold other pages, like folders. Each one can have an icon and a cover.

Databases

Lists where every item is a page with fields: a date, a status, a tag.

Views

The same data as a table, board, calendar or gallery. Switch with the tabs.

Relations

Links between databases. A task belongs to a project, a project to a goal.

> **“Once you get blocks, pages and databases, the rest is just practice.”**

03 Databases, simply

10 DATABASES, 4 YOU'LL USE DAILY

YOUR DAILY FOUR

🗒️ Notes

Ideas, links, quotes

Every day

✅ Tasks

Next steps with a date

Every day

✔️ Habits

Tick what you did

Every day

📓 Journal

Mood, win, thanks

Every day

THE REST OF YOUR SYSTEM

- 🚀 **Projects** — EVERY WEEK
- 🎯 **Goals** — EVERY MONTH
- 🧭 **Areas** — EVERY MONTH
- 📚 **Resources** — WHEN NEEDED
- 📖 **Reading list** — WHEN NEEDED
- 🔁 **Weekly reviews** — EVERY WEEK

Add something

Click **New** on any database, or **+ New page** at the bottom of a list.

Filter and sort

Use the icons above a database. They only change the view, never your data.

04 Your routine

SMALL HABITS, EVERY DAY

☕ Every day

5 min

- [ ] Capture ideas with ⚡ Quick capture
- [ ] Tick today's habits
- [ ] Do the first task in 🔥 Next 7 days
- [ ] Write a 2-minute journal entry

🔁 Every week

15 min

- [ ] Empty the 📥 Inbox: give each note a home
- [ ] Pick the 3 most important tasks
- [ ] Check projects in progress and your goals
- [ ] Add a page in Weekly reviews

🗓️ Every month

30 min

- [ ] Open Monthly review
- [ ] Score each area of your life
- [ ] Write your wins and lessons
- [ ] Choose your focus for next month

🎆 Every year

1–2 h

- [ ] Open Yearly review
- [ ] Score each area from 1 to 10
- [ ] Look back at your best moments
- [ ] Set 3 goals for next year

RULE Capture first, sort later. A rough note in the inbox beats a perfect note you never wrote.

05 Make it yours

YOUR SYSTEM, YOUR WAY

- [ ] **Delete the example data**
  Tick the box on the left of each row and press Delete. Start with Tasks and Notes, then Projects, Goals and Areas.
- [ ] **Rename your habits**
  In Habits, click a column name like "🏃 Move" and type your own.
- [ ] **Change covers and icons**
  Hover the top of any page, then click Change cover or the icon.
- [ ] **Set your areas**
  Write one line in Standard for each area: what "good" looks like for you.
- [ ] **Save templates**
  In a database, click the arrow next to New → + New template. Perfect for your journal.
- [ ] **Try dark mode**
  Settings → Appearance. Your Second Brain looks great in both.

GOOD TO KNOW

Nothing breaks

Everything you change only lives in your copy. Experiment freely.

Undo is your friend

Press undo right away, or restore a page from Trash in the sidebar.

Start small

Use Notes, Tasks and Habits for one week. Add the rest when you're ready.

06 WORK FASTER Shortcuts & fixes

	MAC	WINDOWS
Search everything	⌘ P	Ctrl P
New page	⌘ N	Ctrl N
Undo	⌘ Z	Ctrl Z
Show / hide sidebar	⌘ \	Ctrl \
Dark mode	⌘ ⇧ L	Ctrl ⇧ L
Add any block	/ on an empty line	

I deleted something

Press undo right away, or open **Trash** in the sidebar to restore it.

A view looks empty

Check the filter icon above it. Some views only show this week or open items.

YOU'RE READY

Open *Start here* and capture your first idea.

Need help? Send us a message where you bought this template. We read every message.